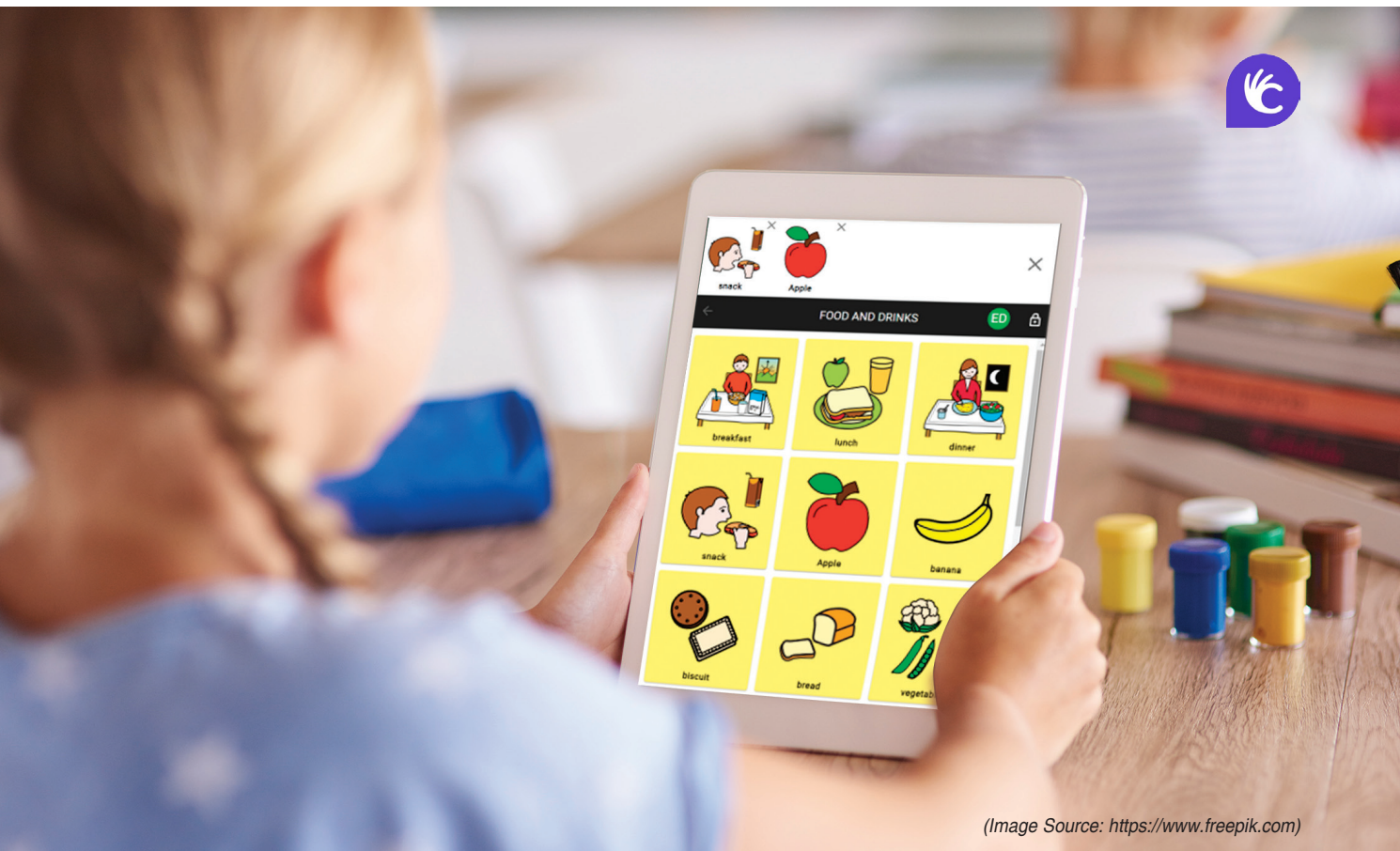


MEETING SPECIAL EDUCATION NEEDS With Open Source Software

Children and adults with special needs require special education. Cboard is a free and open source software for special children, but a lot of work is still needed in this domain, especially in India.



(Image Source: <https://www.freepik.com>)

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It is amazing to see how much selfless collective human effort can achieve. Let me give an example. Almost two decades ago, I got a CD-ROM of Encarta, a digital multimedia encyclopaedia released by Microsoft. At a time when dial-up connections were slow, internet speed was measured in kilobytes, and data was as precious as gold, this CD-ROM of Encarta

was a treasure trove of information for me, a young man from a small village in Kerala. If somebody had told me that within a decade Encarta would be a commercial failure and go out of business because of an encyclopaedia written by volunteers working for free, I wouldn't have believed them. Encarta had articles written by experts in their respective fields who were paid for their expertise,